

THE STEP FORWARD

ACCORD

Version 2.0 | The Airtight Edition

United States of America and the Islamic Republic of Iran

Integrated Twelve-Change Diplomatic Reference | May 2026

"America First, So We Go First"



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Preamble: America First, So We Go First

The United States of America and the Islamic Republic of Iran, hereinafter referred to as "the Parties," enter into this Accord not as a concession to weakness, but as an expression of unmatched American confidence. This is a treaty unlike any that has come before it. It rejects the traditional symmetry of diplomatic exchange, in which mutual suspicion forces both sides to move in locked paralysis, each waiting for the other to blink first.

Instead, this Accord embraces an architecture of sequential leadership: the United States moves first, not because it must, but because it can. America has always been first at everything that matters - first in innovation, first in courage, first in generosity, first in reaching for what others fear to touch. This Accord simply extends that tradition to the realm of diplomacy. The United States does not follow; it leads. And the surest sign of American leadership is the willingness to take the first step toward peace.

The founding principle is elegantly simple: America First, So We Go First. This is not political suicide framed as strategy. It is strategy expressed through confidence. When the strongest nation on earth chooses to move first, it demonstrates not weakness but supremacy - the confidence to act without fear of the other's response.

This framing transforms what might be perceived as a concession into a leadership statement. The first step is not a response to Iranian pressure; it is a unilateral assertion of American confidence and strength. By going first, the United States seizes the narrative initiative and positions itself as the architect of peace rather than a reluctant participant.¹

The Founding Logic of Sequential Leadership

Traditional peace negotiations fail because they demand simultaneous concessions from both parties. Each side waits for the other to blink. Each side fears that moving first signals weakness. The result is perpetual deadlock. History offers abundant evidence: the JCPOA negotiations stalled for years because neither side would move first; the Six-Party Talks on North Korea collapsed under the weight of simultaneous-conditionality; every Middle East peace framework since 1979 has foundered on the rocks of mutual suspicion.

The Step Forward Accord solves this structural problem through radical asymmetry. The United States takes the first step - a bold, unilateral demonstration of confidence that reframes the entire negotiation. This first step is designed to be three things simultaneously: militarily significant rather than merely symbolic, ensuring Iran cannot dismiss it as empty gesture; politically defensible, framed as strength rather than concession; and irreversible in its political benefits, creating momentum that

¹ Game theory research on sequential-move games demonstrates that the first mover often achieves superior outcomes compared to simultaneous-move equilibria. See Schelling, *The Strategy of Conflict* (1960) and subsequent literature on first-mover advantage in diplomatic bargaining.

carries both parties forward even when implementation encounters obstacles.

Iran then responds not because it has been pressured, but because the United States has created a new diplomatic reality that makes Iranian reciprocation the rational choice. The sequential architecture ensures that each Iranian step is a response to an American action - making it politically sustainable for both governments. The United States can say it moved first, demonstrating leadership. Iran can say it responded to American action, preserving sovereignty. Both statements are factually correct.

The Non-Humiliation Doctrine

No party to this Accord shall be required to acknowledge defeat, submission, capitulation, or ideological surrender as a condition of participation. Compliance with Accord obligations constitutes the fulfillment of internationally negotiated commitments, not domestic political surrender. De-escalation is framed as sovereign stabilization - the rational exercise of statecraft in pursuit of national interest - not concession to adversaries.

This doctrine is classified as Tier 1 and governs all Accord provisions, narrative guidance, public communications, and domestic framing. It is binding on both Parties and their respective guarantor institutions. No official communication of either Party shall characterize the other Party's compliance as "surrender," "capitulation," "defeat," or equivalent terminology. Such characterization constitutes a narrative violation and triggers the Quiet Compliance Track remediation procedures.

The Non-Humiliation Doctrine exists precisely because previous frameworks failed in part because participating states feared that framework participation would impair their sovereign authority. This Accord demonstrates that compliance with international obligations and the preservation of national dignity are not merely compatible - they are mutually reinforcing.

Legal Character

This Accord constitutes a binding international agreement between the Parties, entered into under the authority of their respective constitutional frameworks. It is intended to be registered with the United Nations Secretariat under Article 102 of the United Nations Charter upon signature by both Parties.

The Accord operates within the existing international legal order, not as a substitute for it. All provisions shall be interpreted consistently with the Charter of the United Nations, the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea, and other applicable instruments of international law. Where ambiguity exists, the principle of interpretive harmonization shall apply, seeking interpretations that reconcile framework obligations with existing international commitments.

This Accord supersedes the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA) and all related UN Security Council resolutions, including Resolution 2231. The snapback mechanism under the JCPOA is abolished and replaced by the graduated snapback procedures outlined in Section XIII of this Accord.

Section I: Founding Principles and Framework Architecture

Article 1: The Sequential Architecture

The Parties adopt an asymmetrical, sequential exchange architecture as the fundamental operating principle of this Accord. The United States shall take the first step (the "Opening Move"). The Islamic Republic shall respond with a corresponding step (the "Response Move"). This pattern shall continue until all obligations under this Accord are fulfilled.

Each step by one Party must be matched by a corresponding step from the other Party within the specified timeframe. Neither Party moves alone after the Opening Move. The sequence creates what the Parties acknowledge as a "diplomatic waltz" - a synchronized movement in which each commitment by one Party is matched by a corresponding commitment by the other, neither Party is exposed to defection, and verification is shared.

The sequence is not merely a political convenience. It is a structural feature that makes the Accord politically defensible for both governments. The US government can defend the sequencing as the United States moving first, demonstrating leadership. The Iranian government can defend the sequencing as Iran responding only when the United States has moved. Both characterizations are factually correct.

Article 2: The Opening Move

The Opening Move shall be a unilateral action by the United States, taken on the day of signature (Day 1), requiring no prior Iranian commitment. The Opening Move shall consist of three simultaneous actions, each designed to demonstrate American confidence while creating the conditions for Iranian reciprocation.

First, the United States shall immediately suspend all offensive naval operations against Iranian commercial shipping. All active interdiction, boarding, and escort operations targeting Iranian-flagged vessels or Iranian-linked commercial traffic shall cease. US naval assets shall reposition to stations no closer than 50 nautical miles from Iranian territorial waters.

Second, the United States shall declare a permanent ceasefire on all fronts. All offensive military operations against Iranian territory, Iranian forces, and Iranian-linked installations shall cease. This includes a cessation of drone surveillance operations within 10 nautical miles of Iranian airspace and a suspension of offensive cyber operations against Iranian nuclear facilities.

Third, the President of the United States shall issue a public statement affirming that the United States is taking this step because America leads the world, and leadership means going first. The

statement shall frame the Opening Move not as a concession but as a demonstration of American confidence and strength.

This Opening Move is irrevocable once executed. It is designed to demonstrate to the world that American strength is measured not by the ability to dominate, but by the confidence to initiate. The political framing is essential: the Opening Move is not a response to Iranian pressure, nor is it a quid pro quo for Iranian promises. It is a unilateral assertion of American leadership.

The Opening Move is calibrated to be both bold and safe. It is bold because it demonstrates that the United States is willing to take the first step without Iranian pre-commitments. It is safe because the military repositioning preserves US strike capability: naval assets remain within rapid re-strike range, and the 50-nautical-mile buffer provides adequate stand-off distance while maintaining operational readiness.

Article 3: The Framework Stages

The Accord operates through five sequential phases, each building upon the achievements of the previous phase. The modular design ensures that failure in one phase does not collapse prior phases. Early achievements are irreversible once verified.

Phase	Duration	US Obligations			Iran Obligations	
Phase I: Opening	Days 1-14	Naval \$250M release; corridor open	stand-down; pilot asset humanitarian		Hormuz reopening; HEU logistics prep begins Day 1; ceasefire compliance	
Phase II: Stabilization	Days 15-30	25% Sanctions OFAC license	asset Relief humanitarian	return; T1; humanitarian	Fordow conversion plan; enrichment moratorium declared; proxy activity freeze	
Phase III: Consolidation	Days 31-60	SWIFT begins; 50% assets; redeployment	reconnection cumulative IAEA		Fordow execution; full transfer verified; IAEA full access	conversion HEU
Phase IV: Integration	Days 61-90	Permanent sanctions regional dialogue	relief security	IHTA charter; T2; security	Regional Dialogue full verification	Security participation; compliance
Phase V: Normalization	Days 91-180	Full pathway; engagement; 85% assets	sanctions diplomatic	relief assets	Permanent successor opening; full Additional Protocol	compliance; framework IAEA

Article 4: The Five-Channel Verification

Verification shall operate through five independent channels, ensuring that no single actor can unilaterally trigger or block compliance findings. This multi-channel architecture prevents any single guarantor from manipulating the compliance process for political purposes.

0. **Pakistani Political Channel:** Hosted by the Prime Minister's Office, Islamabad. Responsible for political-level compliance certification and dispute mediation. Pakistan's role reflects its proven capacity as mediator, demonstrated through its successful facilitation of the April 2026 ceasefire agreement.
1. **Omani Technical/Maritime Channel:** Hosted by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Muscat. Responsible for maritime compliance verification and Hormuz transit monitoring. Oman operates the Maritime Coordination Cell and the Hormuz deconfliction hotline. Hosts the Joint Forensic Maritime Board for proxy weapon attribution (see Section VIII, Article 44).
2. **Swiss Financial Channel:** Hosted by the Federal Department of Foreign Affairs, Bern. Responsible for sanctions relief verification, asset transfer monitoring, and escrow services. Administers the IHTA toll revenue trust (see Section VII, Article 33) and the Swiss Humanitarian and Commercial Gateway (see Section XI, Article 73).
3. **IAEA Nuclear Channel:** Standard IAEA safeguards plus continuous monitoring at declared facilities, unannounced inspections, remote monitoring with data mirroring to neutral backup nodes, and weekly data transmission to Vienna.
4. **National Technical Means:** Satellite and signals intelligence providing backstop verification of both Parties' compliance. This channel supplements but does not replace the other four verification mechanisms.

Article 5: The Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine

The framework does not supersede, override, or impair the constitutional order of either Party. All framework obligations are implemented through domestic legal processes consistent with each state's constitutional requirements. Where domestic constitutional provisions appear to conflict with framework commitments, the framework provides interpretive harmonization mechanisms rather than supremacy claims.

No framework party may be required to violate its constitutional requirements. The framework does not create any supranational legislative, executive, or judicial body with authority to override national decisions. The governance body operates by consensus or weighted majority on operational matters only. It may not enact binding law upon participating states, override domestic legislative or judicial processes, or authorize military intervention.

Participation in the framework does not impair either state's inherent right to self-defense under Article 51 of the United Nations Charter. All states retain full sovereign authority over national defense policy, military doctrine, defense procurement, alliance relationships, and territorial defense

operations.

Article 6: The Non-Humiliation Protocol

This Protocol establishes binding interpretive principles governing the relationship between this Accord and the sovereign authority of participating states. All framework provisions shall be interpreted consistently with this doctrine, and where ambiguity exists, this doctrine governs.

Compliance with framework obligations - whether nuclear transparency, proxy restraint, sanctions relief delivery, or banking channel normalization - constitutes the fulfillment of internationally negotiated obligations. It does not constitute domestic political surrender, ideological conversion, or admission of prior wrongdoing.

The governance body secretariat shall ensure that all official framework communications describe compliance as: the fulfillment of treaty obligations; the exercise of sovereign choice to participate in international cooperation; the practical mechanism for accessing agreed benefits; and consistent with the long practice of states in international agreements.

Section II: United States Objectives and Requirements

The United States enters this Accord with fifteen core objectives. Each demand reflects a vital national security interest of the United States. Each is accompanied by a corresponding Iranian obligation under the Sequential Exchange Protocol. The following demands are listed in order of priority, with Demand 1 representing the highest priority.

Demand 1: Nuclear Enrichment Moratorium

The United States demands a verifiable moratorium on all uranium enrichment above 3.67% for a minimum period of twelve (12) years. During this moratorium period, Iran shall maintain no enrichment capability above civilian fuel-grade levels. This demand reflects the fundamental US objective of preventing Iran from acquiring nuclear weapons capability.

The twelve-year moratorium represents a compromise between the US position of twenty years and the Iranian position of five years. The landing zone of twelve years is calibrated to the diplomatic reality that both sides can defend this outcome to their domestic constituencies: the United States can cite a moratorium that spans three US presidential terms, while Iran can note that twelve years is finite and that Iran's NPT rights are explicitly preserved.

A material breach of the enrichment moratorium shall be defined as any deliberate enrichment action exceeding 3.67%, or an accumulation of enriched material exceeding a cumulative mass threshold of 50 grams of U-235 equivalent above the 3.67% ceiling within any rolling 30-day period, as verified by IAEA continuous mass spectrometry. Transient isotopic spikes below this threshold that occur during legitimate centrifuge cascade operations shall not constitute material breach and shall be addressed through the Quiet Compliance Track.

Demand 2: Highly Enriched Uranium Stockpile Transfer

The United States demands the transfer of all highly enriched uranium (60% and above) out of Iranian territory to third-country custody under IAEA supervision. This stockpile currently represents the most significant proliferation risk in Iran's nuclear program.

Iran shall transfer its entire stockpile of 60%-enriched uranium to IAEA custody in Oman. Preparatory logistics and verification protocols shall begin on Day 1: joint IAEA-Omani logistics teams shall enter Iranian facilities to package and seal the materials under continuous monitoring. The 72-hour Response Window applies only to the final border-crossing shipping phase (Days 12-14), not to the entire operational chain. The physical stockpile must cross the Iran-Oman border no later than Day 14.

The transfer process shall include: complete inventory verification by IAEA inspectors; mass spectrometry verification of enrichment levels; continuous CCTV and satellite monitoring of the

storage facility; and quarterly verification reports to the Joint Implementation Group.

Demand 3: Fordow Facility Conversion

The United States demands the conversion of the Fordow underground enrichment facility to a non-military, internationally monitored research and development center. Fordow's fortified underground location makes it particularly concerning from a proliferation perspective, as it was designed to withstand aerial attack.

The compromise provides for Fordow to be converted to the International Medical Isotope Research Centre (IMIRC) under IAEA oversight. All advanced centrifuge cascades (IR-6, IR-4, and IR-2m models) must be physically dismantled and moved to a monitored surface storage facility at Natanz under continuous IAEA surveillance, leaving only specialized low-enrichment infrastructure physically modified exclusively for medical isotope production.

Iranian scientists retain senior positions at the facility, and Iran hosts the inaugural International Medical Isotope Summit - transforming a site of proliferation concern into a center of international scientific cooperation. The conversion timeline spans 90 days from the Opening Move. By Day 14, IAEA inspectors gain access for baseline assessment. By Day 30, the Joint Implementation Group approves the conversion plan. By Day 60, all advanced enrichment equipment is removed from Fordow. By Day 90, IMIRC research programs commence.

Demand 4: IAEA Enhanced Monitoring

The United States demands continuous, real-time IAEA monitoring at all declared nuclear facilities, including unannounced inspections. This monitoring regime must be robust enough to detect any deviation from agreed limits while being structured as a partnership rather than punitive surveillance.

The IAEA shall deploy under Sovereign Energy Partnership terms - a framing that emphasizes cooperation over inspection. Continuous monitoring shall operate at Natanz, Isfahan, and the Oman custody facility. Weekly data transmission to IAEA Vienna ensures that any anomaly is detected promptly. Remote monitoring with data mirroring to neutral backup nodes prevents data manipulation.

Unannounced inspections shall be conducted under a structured protocol that respects Iranian sovereignty while ensuring robust verification. Advance notice windows shall be calibrated by facility type, with shorter notice for enrichment-related facilities and longer notice for research facilities.

Demand 5: Proxy Activity Freeze

The United States demands a verifiable freeze on Iranian support for non-state armed groups throughout the region. This demand addresses Iran's extensive network of proxy forces operating in Lebanon, Syria, Iraq, Yemen, and Gaza.

The compromise establishes a proxy activity cap rather than a comprehensive disarmament requirement. Iran shall transmit operational pause instructions to all regional proxies, capping proxy activity at current levels with clear attribution standards. The framework's Proxy Activity Containment Module creates a structured mechanism for monitoring and, where necessary, quarantining spoiler commanders.

Demand 6: Ballistic Missile Range Notification

The United States demands advance notification of ballistic missile tests and development activities exceeding 2,000 kilometer range. The compromise provides for 72-hour advance notification of ballistic missile tests exceeding 2,000km range through the Omani technical channel. No range limitations are imposed on Iran's existing missile inventory.

Demand 7: Strait of Hormuz Freedom of Navigation

The United States demands guaranteed freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz for all vessels, including those of US allies. The compromise establishes the International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA) with permanent US and Iranian co-governance. Joint maritime patrols replace unilateral operations.

Demand 8: End to Hostage-Taking and Wrongful Detention

The United States demands the immediate and unconditional release of all US nationals detained or held hostage by Iran or its proxies. The compromise provides for a full prisoner exchange as detailed in Section V of this Accord.

Demand 9: Regional Base Status Quo

The United States demands preservation of existing US military base arrangements with Gulf Cooperation Council partners. The compromise preserves all US basing arrangements with no changes.

Regarding carrier transits through Hormuz, the Parties shall implement a Cooperative Trans-Strait Transit Protocol. Instead of publishing specific operational windows, both navies shall exchange automated, encrypted transponder data via the IHTA Maritime Coordination Cell in Muscat exactly 12 hours before entering the transit corridor. This preserves tactical security while eliminating surprise friction. The Protocol applies equally to all naval vessels, including Iranian, US, and GCC forces. No special privileges are granted to any party.

Demand 10: Counter-Terrorism Cooperation

The United States demands cooperation against designated terrorist organizations, including intelligence sharing on threats to international shipping. The compromise provides for Iranian Naval

Forces to participate in the Persian Gulf Maritime Security Contribution (PGMSC), contributing to regional counter-piracy and maritime security operations under IHTA coordination.

Demand 11: Cyber Operations Ceasefire

The United States demands an end to Iranian state-sponsored cyber operations against US critical infrastructure. The compromise establishes a bilateral cyber operations ceasefire. An independent cyber verification panel monitors compliance through neutral third-party technical assessment.

Demand 12: Lebanon De-Escalation

The United States demands that Iran use its influence to support de-escalation in Lebanon and prevent cross-border attacks. The compromise provides for Iran to commit to a Hezbollah operational pause on cross-border activities. Full Lebanese settlement is referred to the successor framework (Crescent Compact).

Demand 13: Houthi Red Sea Ceasefire

The United States demands an end to Houthi attacks on commercial shipping in the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden. The compromise provides for Iran to transmit an operational pause instruction to Houthi leadership.

Confirmed Houthi attacks using Iranian-supplied weapons constitute material breach of this Accord. Weapon attribution shall be determined exclusively by the Joint Forensic Maritime Board established under Section VIII, Article 44. This Board, hosted by the Omani Technical Channel and composed of explosive ordnance disposal (EOD) experts from the US, Iran, Oman, and the UN, shall issue binding attribution reports within 96 hours of any incident, utilizing component serial tracing, chemical residue analysis, and signal tracking. No single verification channel may unilaterally declare an attack to involve Iranian-supplied weapons without Board certification.

Demand 14: Gulf State Security Guarantees

The United States demands that Iran refrain from threats or attacks against US allies in the Gulf region. The compromise provides for Iran to issue non-aggression assurances to all GCC states through the IHTA framework. Iran's Persian Gulf Maritime Security Contribution (PGMSC) demonstrates cooperative security intent through concrete operational participation rather than merely rhetorical commitments.

Demand 15: Succession-Proof Architecture

The United States demands that this Accord bind the Parties as states, not individual officials, ensuring continuity across changes in government. The Accord explicitly binds both states under international law. All obligations are state-to-state commitments, not dependent on any individual

officeholder. The institutional architecture is designed to function regardless of which individuals hold office in either Party. The Crisis Pause Mode allows either Party to suspend implementation temporarily during leadership transitions without penalty.

Section III: Islamic Republic Objectives and Requirements

The Islamic Republic of Iran enters this Accord with fifteen core objectives. Each demand reflects a vital national interest of Iran. Each is accompanied by its corresponding United States obligation under the Sequential Exchange Protocol.

Demand 1: End to All Military Hostilities

Iran demands a complete and permanent cessation of all US and Israeli military operations against Iranian territory, forces, and installations. The compromise provides for a permanent ceasefire effective Day 1, simultaneous with the US Opening Move.

Demand 2: Lifting of the Naval Blockade

Iran demands the immediate lifting of the US naval blockade on Iranian commercial ports. The compromise provides for synchronized lifting of the dual blockade on Day 7. Iran opens the Strait of Hormuz to all commercial traffic; the United States simultaneously lifts the naval blockade on Iranian commercial ports.

Demand 3: Return of Frozen Sovereign Assets

Iran demands the return of approximately \$100-120 billion in frozen sovereign assets held in foreign jurisdictions. The compromise provides an eight-tranche asset return architecture that balances Iranian demands for full return against US requirements for conditionality. The pilot tranche (\$250M) is released unconditionally on Day 1 as a gesture of American confidence. Subsequent tranches are linked to verified compliance milestones.

While asset tranches are legally transferred to Iranian ownership on schedule, they shall be deposited into sovereign wealth sub-accounts held in Switzerland or Oman. These assets may be drawn down at a capped monthly rate or converted directly into letters of credit for non-sanctioned industrial trade, preventing capital flooding that could trigger domestic currency volatility or hyperinflation.

Demand 4: Comprehensive Sanctions Relief

Iran demands the lifting of all US-imposed economic sanctions, including primary and secondary sanctions. The compromise provides graduated eight-tranche sanctions relief that proceeds in parallel with the asset return architecture. Humanitarian trade is authorized immediately on Day 1. Aviation safety and consumer exports follow on Day 30. Petrochemicals and oil services by Day 120.

Full banking normalization by Day 365.

The United States further commits that for the lifespan of this Accord, no new economic, financial, or primary sectoral sanctions shall be imposed on Iranian entities unless approved by a unanimous vote of the Joint Implementation Group. If the US Congress passes any new unilateral sanctions legislation, the President shall utilize statutory waiver authority to suspend their implementation for the duration of the Accord. This Sanctions Reciprocity Ceiling ensures that the economic benefits of the treaty cannot be dismantled through parallel legislative action.

Demand 5: Recognition of Peaceful Nuclear Rights

Iran demands recognition of its right to peaceful nuclear energy under Article IV of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. The compromise explicitly recognizes Iran's NPT Article IV rights in the Accord text. Post-moratorium enrichment at 3.67% is guaranteed through a Section 123 Agreement and international fuel supply consortium.

Demand 6: SWIFT Reconnection

Iran demands reconnection to the SWIFT international financial messaging system. The compromise provides for SWIFT reconnection to commence on Day 60 for FATF-compliant Iranian banks. Full reconnection for all compliant banks proceeds by Day 365.

Recognizing that FATF compliance requires deep legislative changes that may face resistance from hardline elements within Iran's parliament, the Parties establish a Swiss Humanitarian and Commercial Gateway (SHCG) as an interim off-ramp. If FATF implementation stalls beyond Day 180, a limited set of pre-vetted, private sector Iranian banks may conduct restricted commercial trade through this gateway under real-time Swiss auditing, keeping the economic track alive while the broader political legislative process plays out.

Demand 7: Co-Governance of the Strait of Hormuz

Iran demands a permanent role in the governance and administration of the Strait of Hormuz. The compromise provides for a permanent Iranian co-governance seat on the International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA) Council with alternating chair authority and equal voting weight with the United States.

Demand 8: Release of Iranian Nationals

Iran demands the release of Iranian nationals detained or imprisoned in the United States. The compromise provides for a full prisoner exchange as detailed in Section V of this Accord. All designated Iranian nationals in US custody shall be released in exchange for detained US nationals.

Demand 9: Non-Interference in Internal Affairs

Iran demands US commitments to non-interference in Iran's internal political and economic affairs. The compromise provides for the Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine (Article 2.2), which guarantees non-interference. The Accord is explicitly transactional and interest-based, not ideological.

Demand 10: Regional Security Dialogue Participation

Iran demands formal participation in a regional security architecture that includes Iran as an equal member. The compromise provides for the Regional Security Dialogue to open on Day 75 with Iran as a founding participant. Iran's Persian Gulf Maritime Security Contribution (PGMSC) positions Iran as a security provider rather than a security problem.

Demand 11: Compensation for War Damages

Iran demands compensation for damages resulting from US and Israeli military operations. The compromise provides for IHTA toll revenue directed to the Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund. However, because the US is a co-governing member of the IHTA, the 30% toll allocation shall be routed directly through the Swiss Financial Channel into a restricted, third-party UN-administered trust. Payments from this trust shall be made directly to international contractors or humanitarian agencies for verified civilian projects, ensuring no capital directly passes through the Central Bank of Iran and thereby avoiding any statutory violation of existing US domestic law.

Demand 12: End to Covert Operations

Iran demands cessation of US covert operations aimed at regime change or internal destabilization. The compromise provides for both parties to commit to non-interference in each other's internal affairs. Independent verification through the Swiss channel monitors compliance.

Demand 13: Preservation of Scientific and Technical Capacity

Iran demands that its nuclear scientific and technical capacity be preserved and redirected to civilian applications. The compromise provides for Fordow IMIRC to preserve Iranian scientific capacity. Iranian scientists lead major research programs. The International Medical Isotope Summit is hosted in Iran, demonstrating international recognition of Iranian scientific expertise.

Demand 14: Economic Reconstruction Support

Iran demands international support for post-conflict economic reconstruction. The compromise provides for a Regional Development Fund with Iranian equal voting weight, IHTA revenue sharing to the Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund through the UN-administered trust, and World Bank technical assistance programs.

Demand 15: Hormuz Naming Recognition

Iran demands that the international designation of the strait reflect its historical Persian identity. The compromise establishes the Hormuz Dual Naming Convention. The official international designation remains "Strait of Hormuz" in all international legal instruments. However, within IHTA commercial shipping documentation only, the supplementary identifier "Trump International Waterway - Hormuz Segment" may appear on toll invoices, transit permits, and commercial shipping documentation.

The supplementary identifier appears only on commercial paperwork - never on diplomatic correspondence, nautical charts, or international legal instruments. Iranian media and educational institutions continue using "Strait of Hormuz" exclusively.

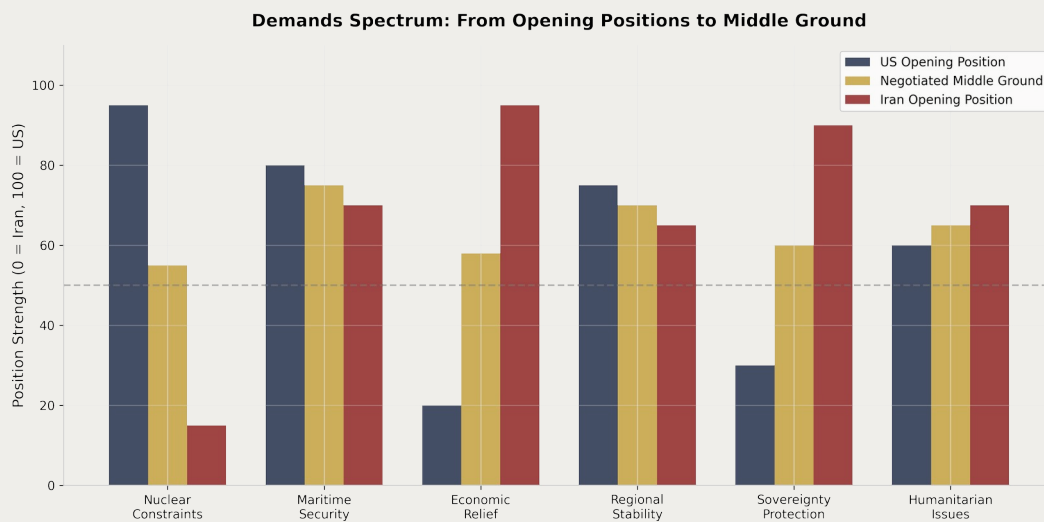


Figure 1: Demands Spectrum - From Opening Positions to Negotiated Middle Ground

Section IV: The Sequential Exchange Protocol

The Sequential Exchange Protocol operationalizes the America First, So We Go First principle through a precisely sequenced set of bilateral steps. Each step by one Party triggers a corresponding step by the other Party. The sequence creates a diplomatic dynamic in which momentum builds naturally as each Party's fulfillment generates political pressure and confidence for the next step.

Article 10: The Opening Move (Day 1)

On the day of signature, the United States shall execute the Opening Move: a unilateral, unconditional demonstration of American confidence and strength. The Opening Move consists of three simultaneous actions.

5. **Naval Stand-Down:** All US Navy combat operations against Iranian commercial shipping are immediately suspended. US naval assets reposition to stations no closer than 50 nautical miles from Iranian territorial waters.
6. **Ceasefire Declaration:** The United States formally declares a permanent ceasefire on all fronts. All offensive military operations against Iranian territory, forces, and installations cease.
7. **The Leadership Statement:** The President of the United States issues a public statement affirming that the United States is taking this step because America leads the world, and leadership means going first.

Simultaneously with the Opening Move, joint IAEA-Omani logistics teams shall enter Iranian nuclear facilities to begin packaging and sealing the highly enriched uranium stockpile for transfer to Oman. This preparatory work begins on Day 1 to ensure that the final border-crossing of the physical

stockpile can occur within the 72-hour Response Window on Days 12-14. The 72-hour window applies only to the final shipping phase, not to the entire operational chain.

Article 11: The Exchange Sequence

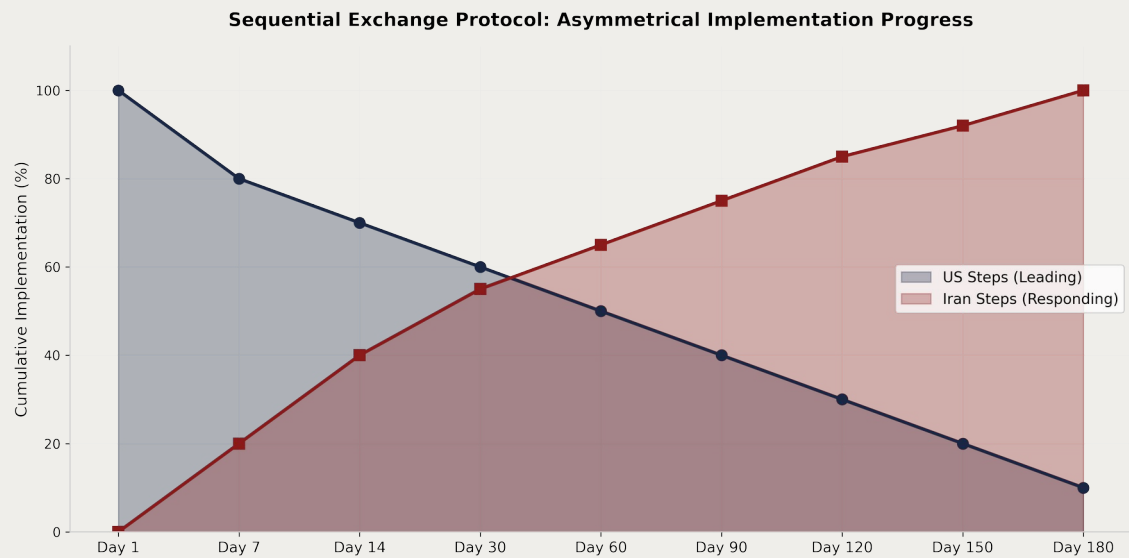


Figure 2: The Sequential Bilateral Exchange Architecture - Seven Steps Across 90 Days

Step	Day	US Action	Iran Response
1	Day 1	Naval Stand-Down; Ceasefire; \$250M pilot asset release	Hormuz transit reopening begins; IAEA-Omani logistics teams enter facilities
2	Day 7	Humanitarian corridor established; dual blockade lifted	Full Hormuz commercial reopening; HEU stockpile sealed and ready
3	Day 14	Second asset tranche (25% minus pilot)	HEU stockpile crosses Iran-Oman border under IAEA custody
4	Day 30	Sanctions Relief Tranche 1; JIG inauguration	Enrichment moratorium declared; Fordow conversion plan approved
5	Day 45	SWIFT reconnection process initiated	Proxy activity freeze order transmitted
6	Day 60	Third asset tranche (25%); 50% cumulative assets	Fordow conversion advanced; centrifuges moved to Natanz
7	Day 90	Permanent IHTA charter	Regional Security

Step	Day	US Action	Iran Response
		signed	Dialogue opened; full IAEA Additional Protocol

Article 12: Synchronization Rules and Response Windows

Each step in the sequence operates under the following synchronization rules that ensure neither Party is exposed to defection:

US Steps after the Opening Move are executed unilaterally but are announced in coordination with Iranian counterparts through the Pakistani political channel 24 hours in advance.

Iranian Response Steps must be executed within 72 hours of the corresponding US step, unless technical requirements necessitate a longer timeline (subject to Omani channel verification). For the HEU stockpile transfer (Step 3), the 72-hour Response Window applies exclusively to the final border-crossing shipping phase (Days 12-14), as the preparatory packaging and sealing operations commence on Day 1 under joint IAEA-Omani supervision.

Article 12A: The Pause Protocol versus Penalty Ladder Trigger

There exists a critical distinction between a minor chronological delay in executing a Response Step and a material breach of Accord obligations. This Article harmonizes the Pause Protocol with the Penalty Ladder to prevent operational confusion.

A minor chronological delay (failure to execute a Response Step within 72 hours due to logistical, technical, or communications issues) triggers the Pause Protocol - a 30-day consultation period during which all other Accord obligations continue. The Pause Protocol allows for technical adjustments without escalation. During a Pause, the Joint Implementation Group shall convene within 48 hours to assess the cause of delay and establish a revised timeline.

Conversely, a formal declaration of intent to non-comply, a physical disruption of Accord obligations, or a verified act that constitutes material breach as defined in Section XIII, Article 95, bypasses the Pause Protocol entirely and immediately activates Level 1 of the Penalty Ladder. The distinction between "delay" and "defiance" shall be determined by the Joint Implementation Group through human deliberation, not by automated technical triggers.

Article 13: The Waltz Philosophy

The Sequential Exchange Protocol follows the Waltz Philosophy of synchronized reciprocal motion. Each commitment by one Party is matched by a corresponding commitment by the other. Neither Party is exposed to defection. Verification is shared. This is not mere political optics - it is structural.

The Iranian government can defend the sequencing as Iran responding only when the United States

has moved first or moved simultaneously. The US administration can defend the sequencing as the US moving first and Iran following. Both characterizations are factually correct. Both are politically defensible. This dual defensibility is the structural feature that makes the Accord survive domestic political scrutiny in both capitals.

The Waltz Philosophy also creates diplomatic momentum. Each completed step builds confidence for the next. Each visible reciprocation creates domestic constituencies for continued engagement. The sequential architecture transforms what could be a zero-sum negotiation into a positive-sum progression in which each step makes the next step easier.

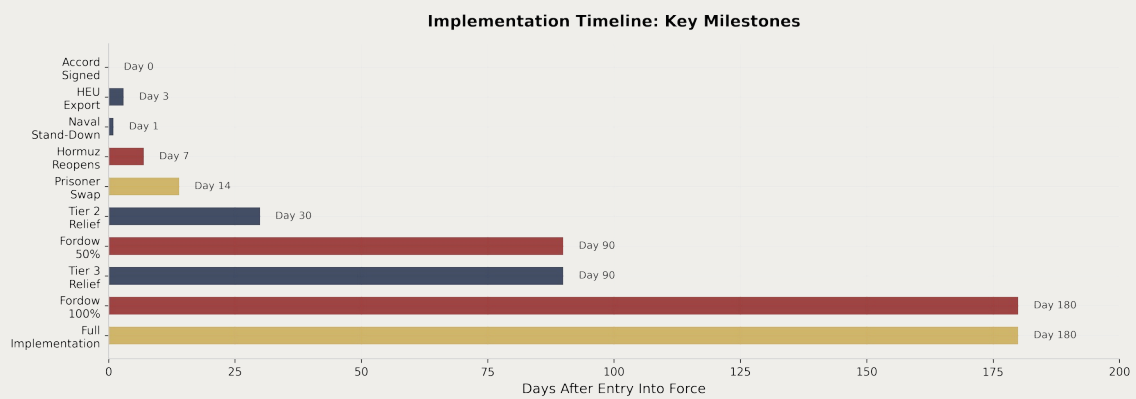


Figure 3: The Step Forward Accord Implementation Timeline - 180-Day Full Implementation

Section V: Prisoner Exchange Agreement

The Parties recognize that the humane treatment of detained persons and their return to their respective homelands is both a moral imperative and a confidence-building measure essential to the success of this Accord.

Article 20: Principles of Exchange

- All exchanged persons shall be treated with dignity and in accordance with international humanitarian law throughout the exchange process.
- The exchange shall be conducted on the basis of parity - equal numbers of persons exchanged simultaneously.
- No exchanged person shall be subject to prosecution, harassment, or discriminatory treatment upon return to their home country for acts committed prior to exchange.
- The exchange shall be supervised by the ICRC as the neutral humanitarian facilitator.

Article 21: Categories of Exchange

Category A: Diplomatic and Consular Personnel

All diplomatic and consular personnel detained in violation of the Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations shall be released immediately upon entry into force of this Accord.

Category B: Dual Nationals

Persons holding dual citizenship who are detained on charges related to sanctions violations, espionage, or national security offenses shall be eligible for exchange.

Category C: Humanitarian Cases

Persons detained for humanitarian reasons, including journalists, academic researchers, and medical personnel, shall be prioritized for early release.

Category D: Security-Related Detainees

Persons detained on charges related to national security, military activities, or intelligence operations shall be exchanged on a case-by-case basis, subject to bilateral agreement through the Pakistani political channel. To prevent this category from becoming a breakdown point, the Parties shall name the precise individuals included in the Category D swap pool prior to treaty execution. The named list shall be attached as a classified annex to this Accord, accessible only to the Joint Liaison Committee.

If a dispute over an individual occurs during negotiation, the disputed person shall be placed into temporary neutral custody in Switzerland under a judicial review panel composed of one Swiss jurist, one Pakistani jurist, and one mutually agreed neutral chair. This procedure allows the remaining undisputed persons in Category D to be exchanged smoothly on schedule while the disputed case is adjudicated. The judicial review shall conclude within 60 days.

Article 22: Exchange Ratios and Numbers

Category			US Persons in Iran	Iranian Persons in US	Exchange Ratio
Category A: Diplomatic			Up to 5	Up to 5	1:1
Category B: Dual Nationals			Up to 15	Up to 15	1:1
Category C: Humanitarian			Up to 8	Up to 8	1:1
Category D: Security-Related			Up to 10	Up to 10	1:1 (named list)
TOTAL			Up to 38	Up to 38	1:1 overall

Article 23: Exchange Timeline

8. **Phase 1 - Day 3:**Category A diplomatic personnel exchanged at the Pakistan-Iran border crossing at Taftan. ICRC-facilitated.
9. **Phase 2 - Day 7:**Category C humanitarian cases exchanged at Muscat International Airport, Oman.
10. **Phase 3 - Day 14:**Category B dual nationals exchanged at Geneva Airport, Switzerland.
11. **Phase 4 - Day 30:**Category D security-related detainees exchanged at the location determined by the Joint Liaison Committee. Undisputed individuals are exchanged on schedule; disputed individuals are referred to Swiss neutral custody for judicial review.

Article 24: Post-Exchange Obligations

- Non-interference with the returned persons' lawful activities.
- No prosecution of returned persons for acts committed prior to exchange.
- Travel freedom for returned persons.
- Access to legal counsel and medical care as needed during the reintegration period.

Article 25: No Additional Detentions

Both Parties commit that, for the duration of this Accord, no new detentions of each other's nationals shall be initiated on charges that would fall within the exchange categories defined in Article 21. Any such detention shall constitute material breach of this Accord.

Section VI: Technical Annex for Prisoner Exchange

This Technical Annex provides the operational procedures, safety protocols, coordination mechanisms, and contingency plans for the execution of the prisoner exchange under Section V.

Annex 6.1: Joint Liaison Committee

A Joint Liaison Committee (JLC) shall be established no later than 48 hours after Accord signature. The JLC shall consist of: two representatives from the US Department of State; two representatives from the Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs; one representative from the ICRC Central Tracing Agency; and one representative from the Pakistani Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

The JLC shall operate from a secure facility in Geneva, Switzerland, with encrypted communication channels, secure video conference facilities, document processing and authentication services, and secure storage for exchange records.

Annex 6.2: Exchange Locations and Logistics

Location Alpha: Taftan Border Crossing (Pakistan-Iran)

Category A diplomatic personnel exchange. Pakistan Rangers maintain 500-meter perimeter. ICRC personnel only within inner 100-meter zone. No military personnel from either Party within 200 meters.

Location Bravo: Muscat International Airport

Category C humanitarian cases exchange. Omani Royal Police secure private terminal. Direct commercial flights to onward destinations arranged by ICRC.

Location Charlie: Geneva Airport

Category B dual nationals exchange. Swiss Federal Police secure private terminal. UN security support available.

Location Delta: JLC-Designated Secure Facility

Category D security-related detainees exchange. The specific location shall be determined by the JLC based on security assessment. For disputed Category D individuals, transfer to Swiss neutral custody shall occur at the ICRC facility in Geneva under the supervision of the judicial review panel.

Annex 6.3: Medical Protocol

12. **Pre-Exchange Medical Assessment:** Conducted by ICRC medical personnel within 24 hours of

exchange.

13. **Continuous Medical Monitoring:** From handover through arrival at final destination.
14. **Post-Exchange Medical Care:** Full medical evaluation provided at receiving state expense.
15. **Psychological Support:** Access to trauma-informed psychological care during reintegration.

Annex 6.4: Communication Protocol

- All JLC communications use encrypted channels provided by the Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs (AES-256).
- No exchange timing, locations, or personnel identities through public or non-secure channels.
- JLC confirms each exchange phase completion within 2 hours of handover.
- ICRC representative has sole authority to suspend any exchange phase pending bilateral consultation.

Annex 6.5: Contingency Protocols

Contingency A: Security Incident

ICRC representative immediately suspends exchange. All personnel retreat to designated safe zones. Host state security forces secure perimeter. JLC reconvenes within 6 hours.

Contingency B: Medical Emergency

ICRC medical personnel provide immediate treatment. Evacuation to nearest appropriate facility arranged by host state. Exchange continues for other persons.

Contingency C: Last-Minute Objection

Objected person's exchange deferred to next phase. All others proceed as planned. JLC reviews within 7 days.

Contingency D: Category D Individual Dispute

If a Category D individual is disputed, that person is immediately transferred to Swiss neutral custody at the ICRC Geneva facility pending judicial review. The remaining Category D individuals proceed with exchange on schedule. The judicial review panel shall render a decision within 60 days.

Annex 6.6: Documentation

- ICRC Exchange Certificate with ICRC seal and all Party signatures.
- Temporary travel documentation valid for transit through intermediary states.

- Contact information for consular support.
- Personal effects returned in condition held.
- Medical records transferred with person's consent.

Section VII: The Hormuz Maritime Protocol

This Section establishes the permanent institutional framework for the governance, security, and commercial administration of the Strait of Hormuz. It supersedes all prior unilateral or ad hoc arrangements and creates a multilateral, treaty-based system that preserves the sovereignty interests of both Parties while ensuring safe, predictable, and equitable transit for all vessels.

Article 26: Establishment of the International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA)

The International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA) is hereby established as a permanent international body with legal personality under the law of the Swiss Federation, where it shall be headquartered in Geneva.

The IHTA Council shall consist of ten members: two from the United States (one diplomatic, one maritime); two from the Islamic Republic of Iran (one diplomatic, one maritime); one from the Sultanate of Oman; one from the Swiss Federation; one from Pakistan; and three rotating seats allocated to other littoral states or major maritime stakeholders on a two-year term.

Council Governance

- The Council Chair shall alternate every 18 months between US and Iranian nominees. No consecutive chair terms by the same Party.
- All Council decisions on operational matters require simple majority vote.
- Decisions on amendments to the IHTA Charter, toll rate changes exceeding 15%, or use of enforcement powers require consensus between US and Iranian representatives (the 'Dual Veto').
- The IHTA operates under Swiss law and diplomatic immunities, with disputes referred to the Permanent Court of Arbitration in The Hague.

Article 27: Dual Naming Convention

The official international designation of the strait shall remain 'Strait of Hormuz' in all diplomatic correspondence, international legal instruments, nautical charts, UN resolutions, and educational materials. This designation is permanent and shall not be altered by any subsequent agreement.

Within IHTA commercial shipping documentation exclusively, including toll invoices, transit permits, commercial shipping manifests, and tariff schedules, the supplementary identifier 'Trump International Waterway - Hormuz Segment' may appear alongside the official designation. The supplementary identifier shall always appear secondary to the official designation, formatted in a smaller typeface or parenthetical notation.

The supplementary identifier shall never appear on: diplomatic correspondence between states; international legal instruments or treaties; nautical charts published by the IHO or national hydrographic offices; UN resolutions or official UN documents; or educational materials in Iranian schools and universities.

Iranian media, educational institutions, and government communications shall use 'Strait of Hormuz' exclusively. The United States may use either designation in its domestic communications without restriction. Both Parties agree not to object to the other's internal nomenclature practices.

Article 28: IHTA Toll and Revenue Framework

The IHTA is authorized to levy transit tolls on all commercial vessels passing through the Strait of Hormuz, based on gross tonnage and vessel classification. Initial toll rates shall be set by the founding Council within 30 days of IHTA establishment and may be adjusted no more than once per fiscal year.

Toll Revenue Trust (Change 5)

All IHTA toll revenue shall be deposited into the IHTA Toll Revenue Trust, established and maintained in Switzerland under the supervision of the Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs. The Trust shall be held in a Swiss-domiciled custodial account, not in any bank located in the United States or under US jurisdiction.

The Trust shall be administered by a three-person Board: one appointee from Switzerland (serving as Chair), one from the United States, and one from the Islamic Republic of Iran. All disbursements from the Trust require at least two Board signatures, including the Swiss Chair.

Revenue distribution: 40% to maritime safety and navigation infrastructure (maintenance of aids to navigation, pilotage services, vessel traffic systems); 30% to environmental protection of the Persian Gulf marine ecosystem; 20% to administrative costs of the IHTA; and 10% to a contingency reserve for maritime emergencies.

No toll revenue shall be used for military purposes, intelligence activities, or activities that could reasonably be construed as supporting either Party's military operations. This prohibition is absolute and non-derogable.

Article 29: Cooperative Trans-Strait Transit Protocol (Change 6)

All naval vessels, including those of the United States, the Islamic Republic of Iran, and GCC member states, shall comply with the Cooperative Trans-Strait Transit Protocol when transiting the Strait of Hormuz.

Transponder Data Exchange

- Both navies shall exchange automated, encrypted transponder data via the IHTA Maritime Coordination Cell in Muscat exactly 12 hours before entering the transit corridor.
- Transponder data includes: vessel identity (hull number or designation), vessel type classification (surface combatant, submarine [when surfaced], auxiliary, or aircraft carrier), approximate transit timing (a 6-hour window), and intended direction of passage (northbound or southbound).
- Exact course, speed, weapons status, and operational orders are NOT disclosed. This preserves tactical security while eliminating surprise friction.
- Data is encrypted using IHTA-issued keys (AES-256) and transmitted through the Omani-hosted secure channel. No third party has access to the raw transponder data.

Transit Corridor Rules

- All naval vessels shall transit through designated corridors marked by IHTA navigation aids.
- No vessel shall deviate from the designated corridor by more than 2 nautical miles without prior notification to the Maritime Coordination Cell.
- Submarines shall transit on the surface or at periscope depth with appropriate identification markers.
- Aircraft carrier transits require 24-hour advance notice through the same encrypted channel, but no additional restrictions apply.
- The Protocol applies equally to all naval vessels. No special privileges, exemptions, or preferential treatment are granted to any party.

Article 30: Deconfliction and Hotline

The IHTA shall maintain a 24/7 Maritime Deconfliction Hotline, staffed jointly by US, Iranian, and Omani officers, operating from the Maritime Coordination Cell in Muscat. The Hotline serves as the primary communications channel for: unexpected vessel encounters; navigational emergencies; technical malfunctions affecting transit safety; and any situation that could escalate into confrontation.

- Hotline response time: officers shall answer within 60 seconds at all times.
- Hotline language: English, with Persian and Arabic interpreters on standby.
- All Hotline communications are recorded, encrypted, and stored for 90 days, after which they are destroyed unless flagged for incident review.
- Either Party may request an immediate Hotline consultation. The other Party shall respond within 15 minutes.

Article 31: Maritime Incident Response

In the event of a maritime incident within the IHTA-administered zone (collision, near-miss, equipment failure, or security concern), the following protocol shall activate automatically:

16. **Immediate Notification:** The vessel involved or its flag state notifies the Maritime Coordination Cell within 15 minutes.
17. **Stand-Down Order:** All naval vessels in the vicinity are directed to maintain position and avoid provocative maneuvers.
18. **Joint Assessment:** Within 2 hours, a joint assessment team (US, Iranian, Omani) is dispatched if the incident involves both Parties.
19. **Incident Report:** A preliminary report is issued within 24 hours; a full report within 7 days.
20. **No Retaliation:** Neither Party may take military or paramilitary action in response to an incident pending the joint assessment.

Article 31A: IHTA Governance Supremacy over Maritime Security Operations

The IHTA is the supreme, neutral, civilian governing authority for all matters relating to the Strait of Hormuz and the wider Persian Gulf maritime domain. All operational security bodies, including the Persian Gulf Maritime Security Contribution (PGMSC) established in Section VIII, derive their enforcement legitimacy from, and report to, the IHTA Council.

Supremacy Hierarchy

- IHTA governance-level decisions supersede PGMSC operational planning in all circumstances. The PGMSC may not authorize, conduct, or direct any maritime security operation that conflicts with IHTA regulations, transit protocols, or commercial shipping priorities.
- The IHTA Council holds exclusive authority over: toll collection and revenue distribution; transit corridor designation and modification; naval transit rules and deconfliction protocols; and sanctions or penalties for maritime violations.
- The PGMSC holds delegated authority over: counter-piracy patrol planning and execution; search and rescue operations; joint training exercise coordination; and tactical-level deconfliction among participating naval forces.
- In the event of operational disagreement, the IHTA Maritime Director's directive prevails over the PGMSC Commander's operational plan. The PGMSC Commander may appeal to the full IHTA Council within 48 hours.

Article 31B: IHTA-PGMSC Operations Committee

An IHTA-PGMSC Operations Committee is hereby established as a permanent coordinating sub-body

that ensures seamless operational integration without governance merger.

- **Composition:** The IHTA Maritime Director (Chair), the PGMSC Commander (Deputy Chair), one US naval liaison, one Iranian naval liaison, and one Omani coordinator.
- **Mandate:** Coordinate joint patrol schedules; resolve day-to-day operational conflicts; share Maritime Domain Awareness data; and prepare consolidated quarterly operational reports for the IHTA Council.
- **Meeting frequency:** Weekly during the first 90 days; bi-weekly thereafter; daily during periods of elevated tension.
- **Decision-making:** Consensus preferred. On procedural matters, the Chair decides. On matters affecting Hormuz transit rules or IHTA regulations, the matter is elevated to the full IHTA Council.

Article 31C: Cross-Representation and Unified Data Architecture

To ensure seamless coordination while preserving structural separation:

- **PGMSC Commander's Council Seat:** The PGMSC Commander holds a permanent, non-voting seat on the IHTA Council, with full rights of consultation and initiative. The Commander may speak at all Council sessions and propose agenda items related to maritime security operations.
- **IHTA Maritime Director's Operational Role:** The IHTA Maritime Director holds a permanent advisory position on the PGMSC Command Group, with authority to freeze any PGMSC operation that threatens IHTA governance priorities or Hormuz commercial transit safety.
- **Unified Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA):** Both IHTA and PGMSC shall feed operational data into a single MDA system, hosted by the Omani Technical Channel. The IHTA holds master administrative rights over the MDA database; the PGMSC holds operational read-write access for patrol and tactical data.
- **Single Deconfliction Hotline:** The IHTA Maritime Deconfliction Hotline established under Article 30 serves as the unified communications channel for both IHTA commercial transit coordination and PGMSC operational deconfliction, supervised jointly by guarantor-state officers.

Structural Resilience Principle

The structural separation between IHTA and PGMSC is a deliberate resilience feature, not bureaucratic overhead. A crisis in PGMSC operations (such as a flare-up in regional proxy activity) does not automatically compromise IHTA governance of Hormuz transit. Conversely, a dispute over toll revenue or transit rules within the IHTA does not paralyze PGMSC counter-piracy operations. Each entity can function independently if the other experiences temporary dysfunction.

Section VIII: Maritime Annex - Persian Gulf Security Contribution

This Section establishes the Persian Gulf Maritime Security Contribution (PGMSC) as the operational and security implementation arm of the International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA). The PGMSC is structurally distinct from the IHTA but derives all of its enforcement legitimacy from the IHTA Council. No PGMSC operation may conflict with IHTA governance directives, and all PGMSC activities are subject to IHTA oversight, audit, and, where necessary, suspension. This nested architecture preserves the IHTA's character as a neutral, international civilian authority while providing a dedicated operational vehicle for Iran's role as a regional security provider.

Article 32: Purpose and Scope of the PGMSC

- Counter-piracy operations in the Persian Gulf, Gulf of Oman, and adjacent waters.
- Maritime search and rescue coordination.
- Environmental protection and oil spill response.
- Humanitarian assistance and disaster relief at sea.
- Counter-trafficking operations (human, narcotics, and weapons trafficking).
- Confidence-building measures and joint training exercises.

Article 33: PGMSC as Operational Sub-Council of the IHTA

The PGMSC operates as an operational sub-council of the IHTA, not as an independent or co-equal body. All PGMSC operations are conducted within the regulatory framework established by the IHTA Council, and the PGMSC Commander reports to the IHTA Maritime Director for all operational matters.

The PGMSC operates through a Regional Coordination Center (RCC) hosted by the Sultanate of Oman in Muscat, collocated with the IHTA Maritime Coordination Cell for operational efficiency but administratively subordinate to the IHTA. The RCC is staffed by military liaisons from all participating states.

Sub-Council Governance

- Participating States: United States, Islamic Republic of Iran, Oman, Pakistan, and all GCC littoral states that choose to join.
- Command Structure: Rotating 12-month command, with US and Iran excluded from the first rotation to build confidence among GCC participants.

- PGMSC Commander's IHTA Council Seat: The PGMSC Commander holds a permanent, non-voting seat on the IHTA Council with full consultation and initiative rights, as established under Article 31C.
- Decision-Making: Operational decisions by consensus; in absence of consensus, the Omani host has tie-breaking authority on procedural matters only. Decisions affecting IHTA transit rules, toll collection, or enforcement authority require IHTA Council approval.
- Budget: Equally shared among participating states, with the IHTA Trust providing supplementary funding for infrastructure and communications.

Authorization and Delegation

- The PGMSC is authorized by the IHTA Council to conduct the operations enumerated in Article 32. Any expansion of PGMSC authority requires formal IHTA Council resolution.
- The IHTA Council may, by majority vote, suspend any or all PGMSC operations for up to 30 days if it determines that such operations threaten IHTA governance priorities, Hormuz commercial transit, or the neutrality of the IHTA.
- The PGMSC may not conduct enforcement action against commercial vessels unless explicitly authorized by the IHTA Maritime Director on a case-by-case basis.
- All PGMSC patrol routes, schedules, and rules of engagement must be filed with the IHTA Maritime Coordination Cell no less than 48 hours before execution.

Article 34: Joint Forensic Maritime Board (Change 4)

The Joint Forensic Maritime Board (JFMB) is hereby established as an independent technical body responsible for the scientific attribution of maritime attacks, vessel seizures, and weapons incidents in the Persian Gulf region. The JFMB shall be the sole authority empowered to issue binding attribution determinations that trigger Accord consequences.

Composition

- Four explosive ordnance disposal (EOD) experts: one nominated by the United States, one by Iran, one by Oman, and one by the United Nations (appointed by the UN Secretary-General).
- Two forensic chemists: one Swiss-nominated, one jointly nominated by Pakistan and Oman.
- One signals intelligence specialist: nominated by a mutually agreed neutral state (initially Switzerland).
- One maritime law expert: appointed by the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS).

Operating Procedures

- The JFMB convenes within 24 hours of a qualifying incident and issues a preliminary finding within 72 hours.
- A binding attribution report is issued within 96 hours of incident notification.
- Attribution methodology includes: component serial number tracing of recovered ordnance; chemical residue analysis of explosive compounds; signal tracking and communications intercept correlation (where legally obtained); metallurgical analysis of debris; and witness testimony from vessel crews and maritime patrols.
- All JFMB proceedings are classified until the binding report is issued. Thereafter, the report is provided to both Parties and to the UN Security Council.

Binding Effect

A JFMB finding that Iranian-supplied weapons were used in an attack on shipping constitutes prima facie evidence of material breach under Section XIII, Article 95. However, no snapback or penalty may be activated until the JFMB report is issued. No single verification channel, including the US Channel, may unilaterally declare an attack to involve Iranian-supplied weapons without JFMB certification. Similarly, no Iranian objection to a finding may delay the report's binding effect beyond a 48-hour review window.

Article 35: Iranian Contribution to PGMSC

The Islamic Republic of Iran shall contribute to the PGMSC in the following capacities:

- Naval patrols in Iranian territorial waters, coordinated with the RCC.
- Port facilities for PGMSC vessels at Bandar Abbas and Chabahar.
- Intelligence sharing on piracy and trafficking networks, subject to the limitations in Article 42.
- Personnel for joint training exercises (up to 50 Iranian personnel per exercise).
- Environmental monitoring data from Iranian scientific stations.

Article 36: Confidence-Building Measures

The following confidence-building measures shall be implemented on the schedule indicated:

21. **Day 30:** First joint maritime search and rescue exercise, conducted in Omani waters.
22. **Day 60:** First counter-piracy patrol with mixed US-Iranian-Omani crews.
23. **Day 90:** Joint oil spill response drill in the Gulf of Oman.
24. **Day 120:** First live-fire counter-traffboarding exercise (simulated).

25. **Day 180:** Full integration of Iranian naval forces into PGMSC operational planning.

Section IX: Nuclear Architecture and Safeguards

This Section establishes the comprehensive nuclear architecture governing Iran's nuclear program for the duration of this Accord. It replaces the JCPOA nuclear provisions in their entirety and creates a new framework based on the principle of verifiable peaceful use with intrusive but dignified oversight.

Article 37: Enrichment Moratorium (Change 2)

The Islamic Republic of Iran shall maintain a complete moratorium on all uranium enrichment activities for a period of fifteen (15) years from the date of Accord entry into force. For the purposes of this Article, 'enrichment activities' means:

- Any process that increases the uranium-235 isotope concentration above its natural abundance of 0.711%.
- The operation of gas centrifuge cascades, including testing, calibration, or standby operation at any speed.
- The receipt, storage, or handling of uranium hexafluoride (UF₆) for enrichment purposes.
- Research and development activities that could reasonably lead to enrichment capability.

The moratorium explicitly does NOT prohibit: the possession, storage, and use of existing low-enriched uranium (LEU) stockpiles up to 3.67% U-235 for civilian purposes including research reactor fuel, medical isotope production, and industrial applications; the importation of enriched uranium fuel from abroad under IAEA safeguards for civilian nuclear power generation; or fundamental scientific research unrelated to enrichment, such as astrophysics, material science, or environmental studies.

Article 38: High-Enriched Uranium Export Protocol (Change 1)

All uranium enriched to 20% U-235 or higher (High-Enriched Uranium, HEU) currently held within the territory of the Islamic Republic of Iran shall be exported to a third-party custodial state within seventy-two (72) hours of Accord entry into force. This timeline is non-negotiable and represents the first concrete Iranian step in the Sequential Exchange Protocol.

Custodial State and Logistics

- Custodial State: The Russian Federation, under an IAEA-Russian custodial agreement.
- IAEA-Omani Logistics Teams: Joint IAEA-Omani technical teams shall enter Iranian enrichment facilities at Natanz and Fordow within 6 hours of Accord signature. These teams, consisting of IAEA inspectors and Omani technical observers, shall verify the inventory, seal the HEU

containers, and supervise the loading process.

- Transport: HEU shall be transported by air from Tehran to Moscow using IAEA-secured aircraft with Omani military escort. Flight path shall be pre-cleared through all transit airspace.
- Verification: IAEA seals are applied in the presence of both US and Iranian observers. Containers are weighed and radiation-signature verified before departure.

Chain-of-Custody Documentation

A complete chain-of-custody documentation shall be maintained: Iranian inventory declaration (submitted at signature); IAEA verification of declared inventory (within 12 hours); seal application and container certification (within 18 hours); transport manifest and flight tracking (continuous); Russian receipt confirmation and independent verification (within 24 hours of arrival); and final certification issued by the IAEA Director General to both Parties.

Article 39: Centrifuge Inventory and Storage

All gas centrifuges at Natanz and Fordow shall be inventoried, catalogued, and placed under IAEA seal within 30 days of Accord entry into force.

- IR-1 centrifuges: Stored in IAEA-monitored warehouses at Natanz. Not destroyed, but disabled through removal of rotors and placement in tamper-evident containers.
- Advanced centrifuges (IR-2m, IR-4, IR-6, IR-8, IR-9): Dismantled under IAEA supervision. Components stored separately to prevent rapid reassembly. Research records transferred to IAEA custody.
- No new centrifuge manufacturing: Iran shall not manufacture, import, or assemble gas centrifuges for the duration of the moratorium.

Article 40: Fordow Facility Conversion (Change 3)

The Fordow Fuel Enrichment Plant (FFEP), located near Qom, shall be converted into the International Astrophysics and Fundamental Physics Research Center (IAFPRC) within one hundred eighty (180) days of Accord entry into force. This conversion is irreversible and shall be verified as complete by the IAEA.

Conversion Requirements

- All enrichment equipment removed: Centrifuges, piping, vacuum systems, and control systems shall be dismantled and removed from the facility.
- Infrastructure repurposing: The underground halls shall be retrofitted for astrophysics research, including installation of particle detectors, cosmic ray observatories, and dark matter research equipment.

- International collaboration: The IAFPRC shall be open to scientists from all IAEA member states, with guaranteed annual research grants from the IHTA Trust Fund.
- IAEA permanent presence: A permanent IAEA office shall be established at Fordow with unrestricted access to all areas.
- Verification milestone: At Day 90, at least 50% of enrichment equipment shall be removed. At Day 180, conversion shall be 100% complete.

Article 41: Arak Heavy Water Reactor

The Arak Heavy Water Reactor shall be redesigned according to the JCPOA specifications to eliminate weapons-grade plutonium production capability. The redesigned reactor shall be completed within 5 years, with IAEA monitoring of all construction phases. Iran shall ship all spent fuel from Arak abroad within 6 months of removal from the reactor.

Article 42: Monitoring and Inspections

The IAEA shall implement the most comprehensive inspection regime in its history, consistent with the Additional Protocol and beyond.

- Continuous monitoring: 24/7 electronic surveillance at all declared nuclear facilities.
- Short-notice inspections: IAEA may conduct inspections with 2 hours' notice at any declared facility.
- Complementary Access: IAEA may request access to any location within Iran with 24 hours' notice. Iran shall provide access or propose an alternative arrangement within 48 hours.
- Environmental sampling: IAEA may collect environmental samples at any location, including non-declared sites.
- Supply chain monitoring: All uranium imports, exports, and domestic mining activities under IAEA monitoring.
- Intelligence sharing limitations: Intelligence provided to the IAEA by either Party shall be shared with the other Party only with the originating Party's consent. Raw intelligence may not be used as the sole basis for inspection demands; it must be corroborated by at least one other verification channel.

Section X: Verification and Compliance Framework

This Section establishes the comprehensive verification architecture that ensures compliance with all Accord obligations. The framework is designed to provide timely, reliable, and politically defensible verification through multiple independent channels, with built-in human oversight at every critical decision point.

Article 43: The Five-Channel Verification System

Verification shall be conducted through five independent but coordinated channels, each with distinct responsibilities and expertise:

26. **The Pakistani Political/Diplomatic Channel:** Hosted by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Islamabad. Responsible for high-level political verification, diplomatic good offices, and crisis mediation. The Pakistani Channel chairs the Joint Implementation Group and has authority to convene emergency consultations.
27. **The Omani Technical/Maritime Channel:** Hosted by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Muscat. Responsible for maritime compliance verification, Hormuz transit monitoring, and operation of the Maritime Coordination Cell. Hosts the Joint Forensic Maritime Board for proxy weapon attribution (see Section VIII, Article 34).
28. **The Swiss Financial Channel:** Hosted by the Federal Department of Foreign Affairs, Bern. Responsible for sanctions relief verification, asset transfer monitoring, and escrow services. Administers the IHTA toll revenue trust (see Section VII, Article 28) and the Swiss Humanitarian and Commercial Gateway (see Section XI, Article 73).
29. **The IAEA Technical/Nuclear Channel:** The International Atomic Energy Agency, Vienna. Responsible for all nuclear-related verification, including enrichment monitoring, facility inspections, and HEU chain-of-custody certification. The IAEA reports quarterly to all other channels and immediately upon detecting any anomaly.
30. **National Technical Means (NTM):** Satellite imagery, signals intelligence, and other national technical collection capabilities operated independently by the United States and Iran. NTM data may supplement but never substitute for on-the-ground verification. NTM intelligence shared with other channels requires originating Party consent.

Article 44: Human-in-the-Loop Verification Requirement (Change 9)

No automated technical system, algorithm, sensor array, or artificial intelligence may, by itself, trigger a compliance determination, penalty activation, or snapback procedure. All verification data must pass through human analytical review before any Accord consequence is activated.

Minimum Human Review Standards

- Every compliance report from any channel shall be reviewed and signed by at least two senior analysts from different national backgrounds before it is transmitted to the Joint Implementation Group.
- Any compliance determination that could lead to snapback or penalty activation requires unanimous confirmation by the three-person Joint Implementation Group panel (one US, one Iranian, one from the chairing channel).
- Analysts are empowered and required to flag ambiguous data, request additional information, and delay determinations when evidence is insufficient. Speed shall never take precedence over accuracy in compliance determinations.
- All human review decisions shall be documented in writing, with dissenting opinions preserved and transmitted to both Parties.

Technical Data Integrity

Sensor data, satellite imagery, and automated monitoring feeds shall be cryptographically signed at the point of collection to prevent tampering. Any gap in data collection exceeding 4 hours at a declared facility triggers an automatic alert to all five channels, but does not, by itself, constitute evidence of non-compliance. Human investigators must determine whether the gap is attributable to technical malfunction, deliberate interference, or other causes.

Article 45: Joint Implementation Group

The Joint Implementation Group (JIG) is the central coordinating body for all verification activities. It is composed of senior representatives from each of the five channels and meets monthly in Geneva.

- JIG Chair: Rotates annually between Pakistan, Oman, and Switzerland.
- Quorum: All five channels must be represented for binding decisions.
- Decision-making: Consensus preferred. On procedural matters, majority vote suffices. On snapback or penalty recommendations, unanimous agreement of the three non-interested channels is required.
- Reporting: The JIG issues quarterly public reports and immediate confidential alerts to both Parties upon detecting potential non-compliance.

Article 46: Compliance Certification

The JIG shall issue formal compliance certifications on the following schedule:

- Day 30: Initial certification confirming completion of all Day 1-14 obligations.
- Day 90: First quarterly certification covering Days 1-90.

- Thereafter: Quarterly certifications on a rolling basis.
- Each certification triggers the corresponding sanctions relief tier under Section XI.

Section XI: Economic Architecture and Sanctions Relief

This Section establishes the economic architecture governing the phased relief of US and multilateral sanctions, the management of frozen Iranian assets, and the mechanisms for preventing sanctions circumvention while enabling legitimate commercial activity.

Article 47: Sanctions Relief Architecture

Sanctions relief shall proceed through four sequential tiers, each tied to verified completion of corresponding Iranian obligations:

Tier	Trigger	US Obligation	Iranian Action Required
Tier 1	Day 1-14 complete	\$250M pilot asset release; humanitarian corridor	HEU sealing begins; Hormuz transit reopens
Tier 2	Day 30 certification	\$2B frozen asset release; medical/pharma exemptions	HEU exported; Natanz centrifuges inventoried
Tier 3	Day 90 certification	\$8B additional release; oil export licenses (1M bpd)	Fordow conversion 50% complete; Additional Protocol ratified
Tier 4	Day 180 certification	Full JCPOA-level relief; IMF/World Bank access	Fordow conversion 100% complete; all nuclear obligations verified

Article 48: Anti-Inflationary Asset Release Mechanism (Change 7)

All frozen Iranian asset releases shall be structured through anti-inflationary sovereign wealth sub-accounts to prevent sudden liquidity injections that could destabilize the Iranian economy or trigger regional inflationary pressures.

Sub-Account Structure

- Infrastructure Sub-Account (40%): Released in quarterly tranches for contracted infrastructure projects (roads, rail, power, water). Funds are released directly to contractors, not to Iranian government accounts.
- Central Bank Reserve Sub-Account (30%): Held as reserve assets at the Central Bank of Iran, subject to IMF monitoring. Released only to maintain currency stability and manage balance of payments.

- Development Bank Sub-Account (20%): Capital for the Iran Reconstruction and Development Bank, providing concessional loans to SMEs and agricultural cooperatives.
- Humanitarian Sub-Account (10%): Medicine, medical equipment, food security, and disaster response. Released immediately upon certification without further conditions.

Release Velocity Controls

No more than \$500 million in aggregate may be released to Iranian government-controlled accounts in any 30-day period during the first year. The Swiss Financial Channel shall monitor release velocity and may recommend slowdowns if macroeconomic indicators suggest overheating. The IMF shall provide quarterly assessments of the inflationary impact of asset releases.

Article 49: Sanctions Ceiling Protocol (Change 11)

In the event that new sanctions are imposed by either Party after the completion of Tier 4 relief, such new sanctions shall be subject to the following ceiling protocol:

- No new sanctions may exceed 60% of the value of sanctions lifted under this Accord, calculated based on the pre-Accord baseline of Iranian trade and financial flows.
- The 60% ceiling is calculated by the Swiss Financial Channel based on IMF trade flow data and is reviewed annually.
- Sanctions exceeding the ceiling automatically trigger the Crisis Pause Protocol under Section XIII, regardless of the underlying justification.
- This ceiling does not apply to sanctions imposed in response to: material breach of this Accord as determined by the Joint Implementation Group; UN Security Council resolutions adopted under Chapter VII; or sanctions against entities specifically designated for terrorism financing by the FATF.

Article 50: Oil Export Provisions

Upon Tier 3 certification, the United States shall issue licenses permitting Iranian oil exports of up to 1 million barrels per day (bpd), increasing to 2.5 million bpd upon Tier 4 certification.

- Pricing: Iranian oil exports shall be priced at market rates without discounts mandated by this Accord.
- Buyers: Any state or entity may purchase Iranian oil, subject only to their own national laws.
- Shipping: IHTA-registered vessels or vessels from non-sanctioned registries may transport Iranian oil.
- Insurance: Standard maritime insurance shall be available for Iranian oil shipments through Lloyd's of London and other major insurers.

- Revenue: Oil export revenue shall be deposited into the Anti-Inflationary Sub-Accounts described in Article 48.

Article 51: Banking and Financial Connectivity

The United States shall permit reconnection of Iranian banks to the SWIFT network upon Tier 2 certification, subject to enhanced due diligence requirements.

- Correspondent banking: US and European banks may re-establish correspondent relationships with designated Iranian banks.
- Due diligence: Iranian banks must maintain FATF-compliant anti-money laundering programs.
- US dollar transactions: Cleared through US correspondent banks with standard OFAC compliance.
- Euro transactions: Cleared through TARGET2 with ECB oversight.

Article 52: Swiss Humanitarian and Commercial Gateway (SHCG) (Change 8)

The Swiss Humanitarian and Commercial Gateway (SHCG) is established as a permanent financial facilitation mechanism for transactions that fall into the FATF compliance grey zone or that are delayed by banking compliance complexity rather than sanctions policy.

SHCG Functions

- Humanitarian fast-track: Pre-cleared Swiss banks process humanitarian transactions (medicine, food, medical equipment) within 48 hours, regardless of FATF status delays.
- Commercial escrow: For legitimate commercial transactions blocked by compliance uncertainty, the SHCG provides escrow services where Swiss banks hold funds pending verification, then release upon confirmation of transaction legitimacy.
- FATF advisory: The SHCG provides confidential advisory opinions to commercial banks on whether specific transactions fall within permitted categories.
- Neutral arbitration: Disputes over whether a transaction is sanctions-compliant are resolved by a three-person Swiss arbitration panel within 30 days.

SHCG Governance

The SHCG is administered by the Swiss State Secretariat for Economic Affairs (SECO), with operational support from five participating Swiss banks. All SHCG transactions are reported quarterly to the US Treasury Department and the Iranian Central Bank. The SHCG does not circumvent sanctions; it provides a compliance pathway for transactions that are sanctions-permissible but practically blocked by banking risk aversion.

Section XII: Guarantor Framework

This Section establishes the guarantor architecture that provides political, security, and economic assurances to both Parties that their counterparts will fulfill their obligations under this Accord. The guarantor framework is designed to create mutual confidence without requiring either Party to trust the other unconditionally.

Article 53: Guarantor States

The following states are designated as Guarantor States, each with specific responsibilities:

31. **The Russian Federation:** Nuclear guarantor. Hosts Iranian HEU under IAEA-Russian custodial agreement. Provides diplomatic backstop for nuclear compliance disputes. Offers technical assistance for Arak reactor redesign.
32. **The Swiss Federation:** Financial and humanitarian guarantor. Hosts IHTA, SHCG, and all escrow mechanisms. Provides neutral arbitration for financial disputes. Guarantees the integrity of the toll revenue trust.
33. **The Sultanate of Oman:** Maritime guarantor. Hosts the Maritime Coordination Cell and the Regional Coordination Center for the PGMSC. Provides maritime deconfliction services and hosts the Joint Forensic Maritime Board.
34. **The Islamic Republic of Pakistan:** Political guarantor. Chairs the Joint Implementation Group and provides diplomatic good offices. Hosts the land border crossing for prisoner exchanges.
35. **The People's Republic of China (Optional):** Economic guarantor. Upon invitation by both Parties, China may provide additional economic guarantees including purchase commitments for Iranian oil, infrastructure investment, and balance-of-payments support.

Article 54: Guarantor Obligations

Each Guarantor State undertakes the following obligations:

- To use its good offices to prevent material breach by the Party it is associated with.
- To provide immediate notification to all other Guarantors and to the Joint Implementation Group upon obtaining credible information of impending material breach.
- To participate in crisis consultations convened under Section XIII within 24 hours of request.
- To refrain from taking any action that would undermine the Accord's implementation while serving as guarantor.
- To maintain the confidentiality of all information obtained through guarantor functions.

Article 55: Guarantor Coordination Council

The Guarantor Coordination Council (GCC) shall meet quarterly in Geneva, chaired on a rotating basis. The GCC reviews implementation progress, addresses concerns raised by any Guarantor, and may issue joint statements of support or concern. The GCC does not have authority to modify the Accord or override bilateral decisions, but its unanimous recommendations shall be given serious consideration by both Parties.

Article 56: Guarantor Withdrawal

A Guarantor State may withdraw from its guarantor role by providing 90 days' written notice to both Parties and all other Guarantors. Upon withdrawal, the remaining Guarantors shall invite a replacement within 60 days. If no replacement is found, the withdrawing Guarantor's responsibilities are distributed among the remaining Guarantors by mutual agreement. Guarantor withdrawal does not affect the validity of the Accord.

Section XIII: Crisis Management and Dispute Resolution

This Section establishes the procedures for managing disputes, responding to perceived or actual non-compliance, and preventing unintended escalation. It replaces the JCPOA snapback mechanism with a graduated, deliberative system that distinguishes between temporary delays and material defiance.

Article 57: The Pause Protocol (Change 10)

The Pause Protocol is the primary mechanism for managing situations where one Party encounters temporary difficulties in fulfilling its obligations but remains committed to the Accord. It is designed to provide breathing room for problem-solving without triggering automatic penalties.

Initiation

- Either Party may declare a Pause by written notification to the Joint Implementation Group and all Guarantor States.
- A Pause may be declared only for obligations with flexible timelines (those marked 'target' rather than 'hard deadline' in the Sequential Exchange Protocol).
- A Pause cannot be declared for: the 72-hour HEU export; the Day 1 naval stand-down; or the Day 7 Hormuz reopening. These are hard deadlines.
- No Party may declare more than two Pauses per calendar year for any single obligation category.

Duration and Effect

- A Pause lasts up to 30 days, extendable once by an additional 30 days with JIG approval.
- During a Pause, all other Accord obligations continue in full force.
- Sanctions relief corresponding to the paused obligation is frozen but not reversed.
- The declaring Party must submit a remedial action plan within 10 days of declaring the Pause.

Termination

- A Pause terminates automatically when the declaring Party certifies completion of the paused obligation.
- If the Pause expires without resolution, the matter is referred to the Dispute Resolution Panel under Article 60.

Article 58: Distinction Between Pause and Snapback (Change 10)

The Accord explicitly distinguishes between 'Pause' (temporary delay with continuing commitment) and 'Snapback' (response to material breach or defiance). The two mechanisms are mutually exclusive pathways.

Dimension	Pause Protocol	Snapback (Penalty Ladder)
Trigger	Temporary logistical difficulty	Material breach or deliberate defiance
Intent	Continuing commitment to Accord	Intentional non-compliance
Effect on relief	Freeze (no new relief)	Progressive reversal of granted relief
Duration	Up to 60 days	Until breach is remedied
Decision body	Declaring Party + JIG	JIG unanimous recommendation
Appeal	None (automatic)	To binding arbitration

The distinction between 'delay' and 'defiance' shall be determined by the Joint Implementation Group through human deliberation, not by automated technical triggers. The JIG shall consider: the declaring Party's history of compliance; the nature and credibility of the reasons provided; the scope and severity of the non-compliance; and any remedial actions already taken.

Article 59: The Penalty Ladder

If the Joint Implementation Group determines that a Party has committed material breach as defined in Article 95, the following graduated penalty ladder shall activate:

36. **Level 1 - Diplomatic Warning (Days 1-30):** Formal written warning issued by the JIG. Guarantor States intensify diplomatic engagement. No economic or military consequences.
37. **Level 2 - Relief Freeze (Days 31-90):** All pending sanctions relief is frozen. No new relief is granted. Guarantor States suspend non-essential cooperation.
38. **Level 3 - Partial Reversal (Days 91-150):** The most recent tier of sanctions relief is reversed. Asset releases are suspended. Oil export licenses are reduced by 50%.
39. **Level 4 - Full Snapback (Day 151+):** Full reimposition of all sanctions that were lifted under this Accord. The matter is referred to the UN Security Council.

The 150-day friction period between Level 1 and Level 4 is deliberate. It provides ample time for diplomatic remediation, ensures that penalties are never applied hastily, and gives both Parties multiple off-ramps before reaching full snapback. No Party may unilaterally accelerate the ladder.

Article 60: Dispute Resolution Panel

Disputes that cannot be resolved through the Pause Protocol or the Penalty Ladder shall be referred to a binding Dispute Resolution Panel.

- **Composition:** Three arbitrators - one nominated by each Party, and a Chair nominated jointly by the Party-nominated arbitrators (or, failing agreement, appointed by the President of the International Court of Justice).
- **Jurisdiction:** The Panel has jurisdiction over all disputes concerning interpretation or implementation of this Accord.
- **Procedure:** Arbitration conducted under UNCITRAL rules in The Hague. All proceedings confidential unless both Parties agree otherwise.
- **Binding effect:** Panel awards are final and binding on both Parties. Enforcement through the UN Security Council if necessary.
- **Expedited procedure:** For time-sensitive disputes, the Panel shall render a decision within 60 days of constitution.

Article 61: Crisis Hotline and Emergency Procedures

In the event of a sudden crisis that threatens to escalate beyond diplomatic management, the following emergency procedures shall activate:

40. **Immediate Hotline Contact:** Within 1 hour of the triggering event, senior officials (Deputy Minister-equivalent or above) from both Parties shall establish direct voice contact.
41. **Stand-Down Orders:** All military forces in the Persian Gulf region shall be placed on reduced alert status. No provocative maneuvers, overflights, or naval exercises within 50 nautical miles of the other Party's forces.
42. **Guarantor Consultation:** Within 6 hours, all Guarantor States convene emergency consultations, either in person or by secure video conference.
43. **JIG Emergency Session:** Within 12 hours, the Joint Implementation Group convenes to assess the situation and recommend de-escalation measures.
44. **Media Blackout:** Both Parties agree to refrain from public statements blaming the other Party for 48 hours, to prevent inflammatory rhetoric from constraining diplomatic options.

Article 62: Material Breach Definition

For the purposes of this Accord, 'material breach' means any of the following:

- Failure to export HEU within 72 hours of Accord entry into force, without invocation of the Pause Protocol.

- Resumption of uranium enrichment above 0.711% U-235 after the moratorium takes effect.
- Interference with IAEA inspectors or destruction of monitoring equipment with intent to conceal nuclear activity.
- An attack on shipping in the Persian Gulf, confirmed by the Joint Forensic Maritime Board as involving Iranian-supplied weapons (if attributed to Iran) or a unilateral military strike on Iranian nuclear facilities (if attributed to the United States).
- Knowingly false compliance certification by either Party.

Section XIV: Final Provisions and Entry Into Force

This Section contains the final provisions governing the entry into force, amendment, duration, and termination of this Accord.

Article 63: Signature and Ratification

This Accord shall be open for signature at the Federal Palace in Bern, Switzerland, on a date agreed by both Parties. Following signature, each Party shall proceed with domestic ratification in accordance with its constitutional requirements.

- United States: Ratification requires advice and consent of the Senate (two-thirds majority).
- Iran: Ratification requires approval by the Guardian Council and the Majlis.
- Provisional application: Upon signature, both Parties agree to provisional application of Day 1-7 obligations on a non-binding best-efforts basis, pending ratification.

Article 64: Entry Into Force

This Accord shall enter into force on the 30th day following the deposit of the second instrument of ratification with the Swiss Federal Council, which shall serve as the Depositary. If ratification by either Party is delayed beyond 180 days after signature, the Guarantor States shall convene to determine whether to extend the signature validity period or renegotiate.

Article 65: Duration and Renewal

This Accord shall remain in force for an initial period of fifteen (15) years from the date of entry into force. Six months before expiration, the Parties shall convene to negotiate renewal or successor arrangements. If no agreement is reached, the Accord automatically renews for successive 5-year periods unless either Party gives 12 months' written notice of non-renewal.

Article 66: Amendments

Any amendment to this Accord requires:

- Written proposal by either Party, submitted to the Depositary.
- Consultation with all Guarantor States.
- Approval by the Joint Implementation Group.
- Ratification by both Parties in accordance with their constitutional procedures.

- Amendments enter into force 30 days after deposit of the second instrument of ratification.

Article 67: Relationship to Other Agreements

This Accord supersedes the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA) and all related UN Security Council resolutions, including Resolution 2231. The snapback mechanism under the JCPOA is abolished and replaced by the graduated snapback procedures outlined in Section XIII of this Accord.

- The Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) remains in full force. This Accord is without prejudice to Iran's NPT obligations.
- Bilateral treaties between either Party and third states remain unaffected, except to the extent they conflict with specific obligations assumed herein.
- UN Charter obligations, including Article 2(4) on the prohibition of force, remain in full force.

Article 68: Withdrawal

Either Party may withdraw from this Accord by providing twelve (12) months' written notice to the Depositary and all Guarantor States. During the notice period, all Accord obligations remain in full force. Withdrawal does not affect any rights or obligations accrued prior to the effective date of withdrawal. Upon withdrawal, all frozen assets shall be released within 30 days, and all IHTA operations shall transition to Omani administration.

Article 69: Category D Exit Provisions (Change 12)

The following provisions govern situations where an individual or entity designated under this Accord requires separation from obligations due to changed circumstances:

Individual Exit

- A Category D individual may petition for exit from Accord obligations if: the original grounds for designation no longer apply; the individual has cooperated fully with all investigative and judicial processes; and a period of at least 24 months has elapsed since the last relevant activity.
- Exit petitions are reviewed by the JLC judicial review panel with Swiss judicial oversight.
- Approved exits are final and may not be appealed by either Party.

Entity Exit

- Entities designated under sanctions provisions may petition for delisting through the Swiss Financial Channel.
- Delisting requires: verified cessation of all sanctioned activities; implementation of compliance programs approved by the Swiss Channel; and 12 months of clean compliance monitoring.

- Fast-track delisting is available for entities that were designated in error or that have undergone fundamental ownership changes.

Article 70: Authentication

This Accord is drawn up in the English, Persian, and French languages, all texts being equally authentic. In case of divergence, the English text shall prevail for interpretive purposes, with the Swiss Federal Council providing certified translations.

Article 71: Depositary

The Swiss Federal Council shall serve as the Depositary for this Accord, responsible for: receiving instruments of ratification and accession; maintaining the authentic text; providing certified copies to all states; and registering the Accord with the United Nations Secretariat under Article 102 of the UN Charter.

Section XV: Political Victory Framing

This Section provides the political narrative architecture that enables both Parties to present this Accord to their respective domestic audiences as an unconditional victory. The framing is based on the principle that both leadership teams must be able to return home and declare success without contradicting the treaty's actual provisions. Each headline below represents the same underlying mechanism described in the operative articles, interpreted through the lens of each Party's political culture, historical narrative, and strategic priorities.

These framings are not mutually exclusive. They are complementary narratives drawn from the same factual architecture. What follows is the domestic political toolkit for ratification.

Victory 1: The Sequential Exchange Protocol

The Mechanism: The step-by-step process where the United States initiates action, followed by reciprocal Iranian verification and compliance (Section IV, Articles 10-11; Section I, Article 1).

Washington Frame: "America First: U.S. Dictates the Terms and Forces Iran to React." The administration has discarded the failed simultaneous-trust models of the past. By enforcing an "America First, So We Go First" paradigm, the United States takes the absolute initiative, setting the pace, deadlines, and verification metrics. Iran is placed on a strict defensive timeline where any failure to comply within 72 hours freezes progress and triggers penalties.

Tehran Frame: "Great Satan Bows: U.S. Forced to Take the First Step." The Islamic Republic's strategic patience and resistance have triumphed. The United States, acknowledging its past unilateral violations, has been forced to legally blink first. Washington is taking the initial physical and financial risks, delivering tangible economic relief before Iran alters its strategic assets, proving that

Washington recognizes Iran's sovereign strength.

Victory 2: The Fordow Facility Conversion

The Mechanism: The physical conversion of the Fordow underground enrichment facility into the International Astrophysics and Fundamental Physics Research Center (Section IX, Article 40).

Washington Frame: "Fordow Silenced: Fortress Enrichment Facility Permanently Dismantled." The most dangerous, bomb-proof underground nuclear enrichment site in Iran has ceased all military operations. Advanced centrifuges have been physically removed from the mountain and placed under IAEA seal. The bunker is no longer a threat to global security.

Tehran Frame: "Fordow Elevated: Iran Becomes Global Leader in Nuclear Science." Our sovereign underground facility remains entirely under Iranian territorial sovereignty and has never been stronger. Instead of shutdown, it has been elevated into a prestigious international scientific hub. Iran's nuclear mastery is formally legitimized on the world stage, with international scientists arriving to study under our technological leadership.

Victory 3: The HEU Stockpile Export

The Mechanism: The extraction and transfer of 60%+ Highly Enriched Uranium out of Iranian territory within 72 hours (Section IX, Article 38).

Washington Frame: "Nuclear Threat Neutered: Iran's Weapons-Grade Material Evacuated." We have successfully cleared out Iran's near-weapons-grade stockpile. By physically transferring the material out of Iran under absolute IAEA and allied custody, we have dramatically extended Iran's breakout time, making a rapid dash for a nuclear weapon practically impossible.

Tehran Frame: "Strategic Assets Secured: Iran Maximizes Value of Sovereign Achievement." We have successfully leveraged our sovereign technological achievements to secure immense economic relief. The material has not been destroyed; it has been safely relocated under a secure international custody framework, serving as an active guarantee that ensures Western financial compliance. Our nuclear program's accomplishments are now the collateral for Iran's economic future.

Victory 4: The Strait of Hormuz Naming

The Mechanism: The dual-naming system where commercial documentation uses a supplementary identifier while official charts and domestic media retain "Strait of Hormuz" (Section VII, Article 27).

Washington Frame: "The Ultimate Brand: Global Shipping Transits the 'Trump International Waterway.'" In an historic diplomatic achievement, the critical choke point of global energy transit now bears an unmistakable stamp of American legacy on international commercial documentation. Every shipping invoice, transit permit, and toll receipt serves as a permanent reminder of American stewardship over global trade routes.

Tehran Frame:"Sovereignty Absolute: The Strait of Hormuz Remains Unchanged." Western domestic political theater has no bearing on our historic waters. All nautical charts, international legal instruments, and regional media firmly maintain the rightful designation of the Strait of Hormuz. Any supplementary commercial notations are strictly external paperwork that do not alter the legal, historical, or geographic reality that this is and always will be the Strait of Hormuz.

Victory 5: Regional Maritime Security (The PGMSC)

The Mechanism: The Persian Gulf Maritime Security Contribution as an operational sub-council under the IHTA, providing Iran a formal security-provider role (Sections VII-VIII).

Washington Frame:"U.S. Navy Anchors Hormuz with Global Oversight and Veto Power." We have integrated regional shipping into a strict international legal architecture where the United States and its allies hold definitive voting rights and veto authority. Any Iranian naval overreach through the PGMSC can be instantly frozen, audited, or penalized by the IHTA's dispute resolution mechanism and the Swiss-Omani guarantor channels.

Tehran Frame:"Iran Named Chief Guardian of the Persian Gulf." The Western dream of unilaterally policing our regional waters is over. Through the PGMSC, the Islamic Republic is formally recognized as the primary, indispensable maritime security provider in the Persian Gulf. Foreign navies must now coordinate through frameworks that respect Iran's defensive architecture and sovereign leadership role.

Victory 6: The Non-Humiliation Doctrine

The Mechanism: Tier 1 binding principles that prohibit toxic, zero-sum language in official communications (Section I, Article 6).

Washington Frame:"Rhetorical Restraint Secures Total Concrete Verification." We traded empty emotional rhetoric for hard, unyielding physical verification. By agreeing to precise legal language, we stripped away Iran's domestic excuses to walk away, forcing them to sign a document that binds them to absolute military and nuclear containment.

Tehran Frame:"Dignity Triumphant: West Forced to Treat Iran as Sovereign Equal." The days of imperialist bullying and arrogant Western dictates are finished. For the first time in modern history, the United States has signed a legally binding accord that mandates absolute respect for the dignity of our revolution, explicitly outlawing the language of subjugation.

Victory 7: The IHTA Toll Revenue and Reconstruction Fund

The Mechanism: Routing a percentage of IHTA commercial toll revenues through a Swiss trust to fund regional reconstruction, including Iranian civilian infrastructure (Section VII, Article 28).

Washington Frame:"Not a Single Taxpayer Dollar Sent to Tehran." We successfully blocked Iran's demands for war reparations. The United States government pays absolutely nothing. Commercial

shipping traffic pays a standard, audited service toll that funds neutral, humanitarian infrastructure projects through a Swiss-supervised trust, completely bypassing the Iranian central bank.

Tehran Frame: "West Pays Damages: Hundreds of Millions Secured for National Reconstruction." Our resistance has forced the international community to fund a continuous, multi-million dollar revenue stream dedicated to rebuilding our civilian infrastructure. This steady capital flow acts as direct compensation for years of illegal Western economic warfare.

Victory 8: Proxy Weapon Forensic Attribution

The Mechanism: A Joint Forensic Maritime Board under Omani oversight that uses component tracing to verify if regional incidents involve Iranian-supplied weapons (Section VIII, Article 34).

Washington Frame: "Iran Held Directly Accountable for Regional Terror Logistics." We have legally tied Iran's hands regarding its regional proxies. By establishing a rigorous forensic attribution pipeline, if Iranian-made components are used in an attack, it triggers an automatic, verified material breach, bringing immediate economic snapback.

Tehran Frame: "End to False-Flag Accusations: Independent Board Stops the Blame Game." We have successfully dismantled the Western propaganda machine. The accord legally establishes that Iran cannot be blamed for the independent actions of regional resistance groups unless undeniable, rigorous physical forensics prove direct supply. No more unilateral accusations.

Victory 9: Category D Security Detainee Judicial Escrow

The Mechanism: Disputed high-level security detainees placed in temporary neutral Swiss custody for independent judicial review rather than a blind exchange (Section XIV, Article 69; Section V, Article 20; Section VI, Annex 6.5).

Washington Frame: "No Blank Checks for Terrorists: U.S. Protects the Rule of Law." We refused an unvetted, asymmetric swap of dangerous security operatives. Disputed individuals are placed under strict Swiss judicial custody for rigorous legal auditing, ensuring that American national security interests are never compromised for a political headline.

Tehran Frame: "Irrepressible Freedom: Our Operatives Rescued from Illegal Captivity." Our wrongfully detained citizens and security personnel have been liberated from cruel, unilateral American prison systems. By moving them to a neutral European jurisdiction under international law, we have shattered Washington's judicial overreach and guaranteed a path to their safe return home.

Victory 10: The Swiss Commercial Gateway

The Mechanism: A Swiss-audited commercial gateway allowing trade for private Iranian banks if domestic parliament faces legislative deadlock over FATF standards (Section XI, Article 52).

Washington Frame: "Ironclad Financial Surveillance: Every Dollar Tracked by Swiss Audits." We have

not given Iran a free pass into the global financial system. If they fail to meet strict international anti-money laundering standards, their banks are confined to a highly restricted, heavily audited Swiss corridor. We maintain absolute visibility into every single commercial transaction.

Tehran Frame:"Sanctions Monopolies Broken: Iran Safeguards Financial Sovereignty." We successfully defended our domestic legislative sovereignty from Western banking dictates. By establishing the Swiss Commercial Gateway, our private banking sector achieves immediate integration with global trade networks, entirely bypassing the legislative traps pushed by imperialist financial institutions.

The Meta-Principle: Architecture of Mutual Dignity

The Step Forward Accord is built on the recognition that sustainable diplomacy requires both parties to claim victory. Every operative mechanism in this treaty has been designed with dual exits: one for Washington, one for Tehran. The asymmetry of the sequencing, the nested hierarchy of the maritime architecture, the dual naming convention, and the graduated penalty ladder all serve this single meta-principle: peace requires political permission from both sides.

This Section is not mere public relations. It is an integral part of the Accord's enforcement architecture. When both leadership teams can defend the treaty to their domestic audiences, the treaty survives political transitions, parliamentary challenges, and regional turbulence. Political durability is structural durability.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF

the undersigned, being duly authorized by their respective governments, have signed this Accord.

Done at Bern, this _____ day of _____, 2026.

For the United States of America	For the Islamic Republic of Iran
_____	_____
President of the United States	President of the Islamic Republic of Iran

Witnessed by the Guarantor States:

- Russian Federation
- Swiss Federation

- Sultanate of Oman
- Islamic Republic of Pakistan

THE STEP FORWARD

ACCORD

Version 2.0 | The Airtight Edition

"America First, So We Go First"

Integrated Twelve-Change Diplomatic Reference

May 2026

"Peace is not absence of conflict, it is the ability to handle conflict by peaceful means."

- Ronald Reagan